

INTERRUPT - Master Taxonomy & AI Video Prompt Library

A Complete System of Visual Pattern Interrupts for Viral Short-Form Video

For AI Video Generation (Veo, Kling, Seedance, Runway, Pika, Luma, Hailuo, Sora)

START HERE - Which Interrupt Should I Use?

Before choosing a prompt, choose the job the opening needs to do. The technique is the mechanism. The emotion and content objective determine which mechanism is appropriate.

Your goal | Start with | Why

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****Awe / wonder**** | Gravity & Physics, Scale & Proportion | Breaks physical expectations immediately

****Curiosity / mystery**** | Impossible Objects, Mirror & Symmetry, Time Manipulation | Creates an unanswered visual question

****Unease / uncanny**** | Mirror & Symmetry, Body & Anatomy, Emotion Subversion | Violates a familiar human expectation

****Energy / intensity**** | Camera & Perspective, Glitch & Corruption | Creates movement or visual instability

****Premium / aesthetic**** | Material & Texture, Light & Color | Makes the visual itself the attraction

****Mute-first communication**** | Typography & Text, Light & Color | Carries meaning visually without relying on audio

****Teaching / demonstration**** | Time Manipulation, Scale & Proportion, Typography & Text | Makes a concept visible quickly

****Story / reveal**** | Emotion Subversion, Impossible Objects, Time Manipulation | Opens a narrative question

****Product / brand attention**** | Light & Color, Material & Texture, Scale & Proportion | Keeps the product central while breaking expectation

The three-question shortcut

1. What should the viewer feel? Awe, curiosity, unease, energy, delight, or recognition? 2. What must the viewer understand without sound? If yes, favor visually legible mechanisms such as text, contrast, scale, or physical transformation. 3. What is the content asking the viewer to do next? Watch a reveal, learn something, feel something, or consider a product?

Choose one primary interrupt. Add a second technique only when it strengthens the first.

The attention sequence

0.0-0.8s: INTERRUPT - break expectation or create a strong salience spike.

0.8-1.5s: IDENTITY - make the viewer understand why this matters to them.

1.5-3.0s: OPEN LOOP - create a question, tension, promise, or unresolved transformation that rewards continued viewing.

IMPORTANT - How To Use This (and How Not To)

This is an original taxonomy I built from the mechanics of viral short-form video and how AI video models actually behave. It is not a reproduction of anyone's proprietary prompt library. If someone claims "5,000 interruptors," treat that as a marketing number, not a methodology - the underlying *patterns* are finite and nameable. This document names them.

For your digital product: teach the **patterns and the psychology**, and write your **own** prompts for each. Never resell another creator's prompt text verbatim - that's both legally risky and a weak product. What you're selling is the **system**, the **naming**, and the **judgment** of which interrupt to use when. That's defensible, teachable, and yours.

How to read each entry: - Name - what to call it (use these names in your product; consistent naming = memorability) - What it is - the mechanism, in one or two lines - Why it stops the scroll - the psychology - AI prompt - a copy-paste starting point (swap `[brackets]`) - Negative prompt - the failure modes to exclude

PART 0 - The Psychology (Why Interrupters Work)

Every scroll interrupter does one of three things to the brain in the first 0.8 seconds:

1. Reality violation - the brain detects "that shouldn't be possible" and stops to resolve the error. (Surreal physics, impossible objects, material swaps.)
2. Signal salience - something is so visually loud, novel, or emotionally charged it overrides the autopilot scroll. (Glitch, neon, extreme contrast, a face in distress.)
3. Open loop / incomplete information - the brain is handed a puzzle it must close. (A door opening to something unknown, a mask cracking, an interrupted motion.)

All three hijack the same mechanism the HOOK_GUIDE defines: Pattern Interrupt (0-0.8s) → Identity Signal (0.8-1.5s) → Open Loop (1.5-3s).

The interrupt is **only the first frame**. It buys you 3 seconds. The hook architecture then has to deliver.

PART 1 - The 12 Categories & Named Techniques

CATEGORY 1: GRAVITY & PHYSICS BREAKS

The brain's most primal expectation is that things fall down. Breaking gravity is the fastest possible reality violation.

1.1 - The Float (Levitation)

What it is: A subject or object hovers in mid-air, bobbing slightly, defying gravity. Why it stops: Pure reality violation. "That's not supposed to stay up there."

AI prompt:

A [object/person] floats in mid-air, gently bobbing and rotating slowly, with no visible support, against [a clean/blurred background]. Subtle weightless drift, soft realistic lighting and shadow below showing it is suspended. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: strings, wires, visible hand, falling, resting on a surface, gravity, ground contact.

1.2 - The Fall (Falling Through Frame)

What it is: A character enters from the top and falls straight down, limbs moving naturally, exiting the bottom. (This is the example you were shown.) Why it stops: The motion is continuous and un-ignorable; the brain tracks the fall.

AI prompt:

A [character] enters from the top of the frame and falls straight down through the center until they exit at the bottom. While falling, they move arms and legs in continuous natural motion - arms bend, hands shift, legs softly kick. Keep the movement visible but subtle, fluid, realistic. Static [background description]. Locked camera, no zoom, pan, tilt, or rotation. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: frozen limbs, rigid pose, standing, walking, floating upright, floor, ground, portal, extra limbs, distorted anatomy, CGI artifacts.

1.3 - Reverse Gravity (Things Fall Up)

What it is: Objects rise instead of falling - rain falling upward, hair defying gravity, a person walking on the ceiling. Why it stops: A direct inversion of the most basic physics expectation.

AI prompt:

Reverse gravity effect: [liquid/rain/objects/hair] rises upward instead of falling, defying gravity in a dreamlike but physically-lit scene. The subject [moves normally] while the world's gravity is inverted around them. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: normal falling, gravity, downward motion, realistic physics.

1.4 - Zero-G / Weightlessness

What it is: Everything in the frame floats - a room of suspended objects, a person drifting like in space. Why it stops: Multiple simultaneous reality violations are more arresting than one.

AI prompt:

Zero-gravity scene: [a person and surrounding objects] float weightlessly, drifting slowly and colliding softly, hair and fabric suspended, in a [room/environment]. Soft volumetric light, dust motes floating. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: gravity, objects resting on surfaces, falling, grounded, normal physics.

1.5 - The Ground Opens (Falling Into a Hole / Portal)

What it is: The floor opens beneath the subject, who falls backward into a hole that wasn't there. Why it stops: The ground is the most "safe" surface - violating it is deeply destabilizing.

AI prompt:

Frame stays static while a character takes a step backward as a [dark hole/portal] opens in the ground behind them and they fall backward into it, feet last. Camera position stays fixed, no zoom or pan. The hole glows faintly at its edges. 9:16.

Negative prompt: character walking forward, staying on ground, hole closing, camera movement, jumping, levitating.

CATEGORY 2: SCALE & PROPORTION DISTORTION

2.1 - Giant Object / Tiny Subject

What it is: A normal object is impossibly huge, or the subject is impossibly small. Why it stops: The brain instantly registers the scale mismatch as "wrong."

AI prompt:

A [tiny person] stands next to a [gigantic normal object, e.g., a strawberry the size of a house], emphasizing extreme scale contrast. Photorealistic, soft lighting, shallow depth of field. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: normal scale, proportional objects, flat, miniature without context.

2.2 - Shrink / Grow

What it is: The subject or object continuously shrinks or grows within a single shot. Why it stops:

Continuous, impossible scale change forces the eye to track it.

AI prompt:

A [person/object] continuously [shrinks/grows] in real time while the background stays constant, creating an impossible scale shift. Smooth, gradual, physically lit. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: static size, sudden jumps, camera zoom (the scale change must be on the subject, not the camera).

2.3 - Extreme Zoom (Macro to Cosmic)

What it is: The camera zooms impossibly far - from a seed into its cells, or from a face out to the galaxy.

Why it stops: The journey through scale is hypnotic and disorienting.

AI prompt:

An impossible continuous zoom: start at [a tiny detail, e.g., a seed] and pull back continuously through [increasingly large scales] until reaching [a cosmic scale, e.g., the whole planet]. Seamless, no cuts, smooth motion. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: jump cuts, jerky zoom, static framing, breaks in continuity.

2.4 - Miniature World (Tilt-Shift / Toy Effect)

What it is: A real scene rendered as if it's a tiny toy model. Why it stops: Familiar scenes look suddenly "fake" and cute - a curiosity hook.

AI prompt:

Tilt-shift miniature effect: [a real scene, e.g., a farm, a city street] rendered as a tiny, hyper-detailed toy model. Shallow depth of field, exaggerated saturation, everything looks like a miniature diorama. Locked camera, 9:16.

Negative prompt: normal depth of field, realistic scale, full-size realism.

CATEGORY 3: TIME MANIPULATION

3.1 - Time Freeze (One Moving Element)

What it is: The whole world is frozen - water suspended, people mid-motion - except ONE element that still moves. Why it stops: The contrast between frozen and moving is hypnotic and creates an instant "how is this happening" open loop.

AI prompt:

Time-freeze effect: the entire scene is frozen - [water droplets suspended in air, people mid-motion, objects floating] - except a single [hand/person/object] that moves normally through the frozen world. Sharp contrast between motion and stillness. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: everything moving, nothing frozen, blurry motion, normal time.

3.2 - Time Reversal (Un-Growing / Rewind)

What it is: Action runs backward - a leaf folds back into a bud, water flows upward into a glass, a flower un-blooms. Why it stops: Reversed motion of a recognizable process is deeply disorienting.

AI prompt:

Reverse-time effect: [a recognizable process, e.g., a flower blooming, water pouring, a building collapsing] plays in reverse - [the flower folds back into a bud, water flows upward into the glass]. Smooth, physically realistic lighting, no indication of it being played backward. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.
Negative prompt: normal forward motion, obvious rewind artifacts, jerky reversal.

3.3 - Hyper Slow-Mo (Ultra Detail)

What it is: A fast, chaotic moment - a splash, a shatter, a burst - slowed to a crawl, revealing detail invisible to the naked eye. Why it stops: Novelty. The brain has never *seen* these moments clearly before.

AI prompt:

Ultra slow-motion: [a fast event, e.g., a water balloon bursting, a pepper being sliced, seeds scattering] at extreme slow motion, every droplet and fragment crisp and detailed. High-speed-camera aesthetic, sharp focus, dramatic lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.
Negative prompt: normal speed, motion blur, low detail, unclear subject.

3.4 - Time-Lapse Rush

What it is: A slow process - a plant growing, a day passing - compressed into seconds. Why it stops: Seeing a "hidden" process (growth, transformation) feels like privileged knowledge.

AI prompt:

Time-lapse: [a slow natural process, e.g., a seed sprouting into a full plant, a sunrise-to-sunset] compressed into a few seconds, with smooth continuous growth and changing light. Seamless, no jumps. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.
Negative prompt: jump cuts, static growth, same lighting throughout, broken continuity.

3.5 - Perfect Loop (Infinite Motion)

What it is: The motion loops seamlessly so the viewer can't find the start or end - hypnotic. Why it stops: The brain tries to find the seam and fails, staying to figure it out.

AI prompt:

Seamless infinite loop: [a continuous motion, e.g., a ball rolling through a maze, a hand repeatedly tossing and catching, a spinning object] that loops perfectly with no visible start or end point. The first and last frame are identical. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.
Negative prompt: visible loop seam, changing position between loops, breaks in motion.

CATEGORY 4: GLITCH & DIGITAL CORRUPTION

4.1 - Glitch / Scanline Corruption

What it is: The image tears, distorts, and corrupts with digital glitch artifacts. Why it stops: A sudden "broken screen" is a high-salience signal - the brain checks if the device is breaking.

AI prompt:

Digital glitch effect: [a subject/action] becomes corrupted by [glitch artifacts, RGB split, scanlines, pixel displacement], as if the video signal is breaking down, then momentarily recovers. Cyberpunk or VHS glitch aesthetic. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: clean image, no distortion, smooth motion, static glitch throughout.

4.2 - Pixel Dissolve (Matter Becomes Pixels)

What it is: A subject or object disintegrates into pixels, particles, or digital dust and reassembles. Why it stops: The "matter → data" transformation is a clean, satisfying visual magic trick.

AI prompt:

Pixel-dissolve effect: a [person/object] disintegrates into [glowing pixels/digital particles] that drift apart, then reassembles back into solid form. Smooth transition, futuristic clean aesthetic. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: hard cut, no transition, disappearing without particles, smoke instead of pixels.

4.3 - VHS / Screen Tear

What it is: The video looks like degraded VHS tape - tracking errors, color bleed, horizontal tearing. Why it stops: Retro-degradation stands out against clean, modern feeds.

AI prompt:

VHS tape aesthetic: [a subject/action] shot as degraded analog video - horizontal tracking errors, color bleed, scanlines, grain, occasional signal loss. Warm retro color cast. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: clean digital, modern clarity, no grain, stable image.

4.4 - Liquify / Melt

What it is: The subject or background melts, drips, or warps like liquid. Why it stops: A stable object becoming fluid is a clean reality violation.

AI prompt:

Liquify effect: [a subject/object] begins to melt and drip downward like [water/paint/honey], warping and distorting while retaining recognizable features. Surreal, smooth, glossy liquid lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: solid form, rigid, no distortion, frozen, dry texture.

4.5 - Data-Mosh / Compression Artifact

What it is: Motion causes blocks of the image to smear and lag, like a corrupted video file. Why it stops: It looks "broken" - the brain investigates the error.

AI prompt:

Data-mosh effect: when [the subject moves], blocks of the image smear, lag, and distort, creating a corrupted-compression aesthetic, as if the video file is failing. Saturated colors, digital artifacts. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: clean motion, no artifacts, stable pixels, smooth footage.

CATEGORY 5: MATERIAL & TEXTURE SWAPS

5.1 - Sand / Water / Smoke Person (Material Morph)

What it is: The subject is made of - or dissolves into - an unexpected material (sand, water, smoke, fire, liquid metal). Why it stops: A human form in a non-human material is a strong, memorable reality violation.

AI prompt:

A [person] is made of / dissolves into [flowing sand / clear water / drifting smoke / liquid metal]. The material behaves realistically - [the sand pours, the water ripples, the smoke drifts], while the human silhouette remains recognizable. Dramatic lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: solid flesh, rigid material, no particle motion, static texture.

5.2 - Paper Collage / Mixed-Media Cutout

What it is: The subject is a cut-out paper collage over a textured background, moving with subtle stop-motion. (This is the "Falling 1" style from your example.) Why it stops: The handmade, analog texture is a jarring contrast to glossy AI/CGI feeds.

AI prompt:

Mixed-media paper collage: a [subject] is a recognizable full-color cutout with a thin, uneven white paper border, moving with subtle natural motion over a static [collage background of torn paper, photocopy textures, clouds, grain]. Analog zine imperfections, soft shadows between layers, 9:16 vertical. Locked camera.

Negative prompt: CGI, glossy 3D, clean vector, realistic person, no paper texture, text, watermark.

5.3 - 3D-to-2D Flatten

What it is: A 3D subject collapses into a flat 2D shape (or vice versa), like a pop-up book. Why it stops: The dimension switch is a clean, satisfying "how did that happen" moment.

AI prompt:

A [3D subject] smoothly flattens into a [2D flat illustration / paper cutout / silhouette], then unfolds back to 3D. The transition is seamless, the 2D and 3D versions match perfectly. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: hard cut, mismatched forms, no transition, both states identical.

5.4 - Glass / Ice / Crystal

What it is: The subject is translucent glass or crystalline ice, catching and refracting light. Why it stops: Translucency and refraction are visually novel and "expensive-looking."

AI prompt:

A [subject] made of [clear glass / ice / crystal], translucent and refracting light, with internal reflections and subtle refractions. Slowly rotates or performs a small motion. Clean studio lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: opaque, solid, no refraction, dull material, no light interaction.

5.5 - Particle Dissolve (Leaves / Dust / Sparkles)

What it is: The subject bursts into leaves, petals, dust, or sparkles and reforms. Why it stops: Satisfying, magical, and visually "shareable."

AI prompt:

A [subject/object] bursts into [thousands of leaves / flower petals / glowing dust particles] that scatter and swirl, then converge back and reform into the

solid form. Smooth, cinematic, warm lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: hard cut, smoke instead of particles, no reassembly, disappearing permanently.

5.6 - Claymation / Stop-Motion

What it is: The whole scene is rendered as plasticine/clay with visible fingerprints and jerky stop-motion.

Why it stops: The tactile, handmade aesthetic cuts through glossy content.

AI prompt:

Claymation / stop-motion style: [a subject and scene] rendered as plasticine clay with visible fingerprints and imperfect handmade texture, moving in subtle stop-motion. Warm soft lighting, charming imperfections, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: smooth CGI, realistic skin, clean vector, no texture, fluid 60fps motion.

CATEGORY 6: MIRROR & SYMMETRY

6.1 - Infinite Mirror (Recursion)

What it is: The subject is reflected infinitely - a mirror reflecting a mirror reflecting a mirror. Why it stops: The infinite regression is disorienting and the brain tries to find the "end."

AI prompt:

Infinite mirror recursion: [a subject stands between two mirrors / holds a mirror facing itself], creating an infinitely repeating reflection that recedes into the distance. Each reflection is a slightly smaller copy. Cinematic lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: single reflection, no recursion, flat mirror, no depth.

6.2 - Reflection Mismatch (The Reflection Speaks Back)

What it is: The reflection in the mirror does something different from the subject - blinks, smiles, looks away, or moves independently. Why it stops: A subtle, creepy reality violation - the brain notices the mismatch and is unsettled.

AI prompt:

A [subject] looks into a mirror, and their reflection [does something the subject does not - blinks slowly, smiles wider, looks away, or moves independently]. The subject is still while the reflection acts. Subtle, uncanny, realistic lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: reflection matching subject, no mismatch, cartoonish, exaggerated.

6.3 - Kaleidoscope Symmetry

What it is: The frame becomes a kaleidoscope - radial, mirrored, trippy symmetry. Why it stops: Extreme symmetrical complexity is hypnotic and visually loud.

AI prompt:

Kaleidoscope effect: [a subject/pattern] multiplied into radial mirrored symmetry, rotating slowly, creating a hypnotic repeating mandala. Vibrant colors, clean geometric precision, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: asymmetric, single image, no mirroring, flat, static.

6.4 - Split-Screen Impossible

What it is: Two halves of the frame don't align - a person's top and bottom halves from different scenes, or two people in one body. Why it stops: The misalignment creates an instant "wait, what am I looking at" moment.

AI prompt:

Split-screen impossible: the top half of the frame shows [one scene/subject] and the bottom half shows [a completely different scene/subject], seamlessly joined at a clean horizontal seam so they appear to be one continuous but impossible image. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: mismatched seam, broken join, two separate videos, no continuity.

CATEGORY 7: IMPOSSIBLE OBJECTS & SURREAL SPACE

7.1 - The Door / Portal to Somewhere Else

What it is: A door, window, or portal opens onto a scene that shouldn't be there - a beach in a bedroom, a field inside an office. Why it stops: The "door to another world" is a powerful open loop - the brain must see what's through it.

AI prompt:

A [door/window/portal] opens to reveal [an impossible scene - a beach, a forest, a galaxy, another room] that cannot exist in its location. The subject [walks through / looks through]. Seamless, cinematic lighting on both sides, 9:16.

Negative prompt: empty doorway, black void, no revealed scene, broken seam.

7.2 - Object Out of Place

What it is: A normal object appears where it categorically shouldn't - a whale in a swimming pool, a tree growing from a desk, a door in a field. Why it stops: The absurd juxtaposition is instantly attention-grabbing and shareable.

AI prompt:

A [huge ordinary object, e.g., a whale / a tree / a door] appears in [a place it cannot belong, e.g., a swimming pool / an office desk / a farm field], fully photorealistic and lit consistently with the scene. Locked camera, 9:16.

Negative prompt: object blending in, believable placement, no contrast, flat lighting.

7.3 - Impossible Architecture (Escher / Penrose)

What it is: Stairs that loop back on themselves, rooms with gravity going in two directions, M.C. Escher-style geometry. Why it stops: The brain's spatial reasoning fails and it stays to resolve the paradox.

AI prompt:

Impossible architecture: [a staircase / room] in the style of M.C. Escher, where [stairs loop back onto themselves / gravity points in multiple directions]. Surreal, geometrically precise, clean lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: normal architecture, possible geometry, flat, no paradox.

7.4 - Living Objects (Objects With Faces / Eyes)

What it is: Inanimate objects come alive - a coffee mug blinks, a pepper has a face and reacts. Why it stops: Anthropomorphism is cute/creepy and highly shareable (strong in food/CPG content).

AI prompt:

A [normal object, e.g., a coffee mug / a pepper / a shoe] comes alive with [a simple expressive face / subtle animation], reacting to [something off-screen].

Charming, minimal, personality-driven, photorealistic or soft 3D, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: inanimate, static object, no expression, horror, overly detailed face.

CATEGORY 8: BODY & ANATOMY DISTORTION

8.1 - Duplicated Limbs / Extra Hands

What it is: The subject has extra hands, arms, or other limbs doing multiple things at once. Why it stops: Extra anatomy is a strong, slightly uncanny reality violation.

AI prompt:

A [person] has [extra hands / extra arms] that move independently and naturally, all performing [a task] simultaneously. The extra limbs emerge smoothly from the body with realistic anatomy and lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: missing limbs, extra limbs floating, distorted anatomy, wrong number of fingers.

8.2 - Head / Body Swap

What it is: Heads on the wrong bodies, or faces swapped between two people. Why it stops: The mismatch is immediately recognizable and unsettling.

AI prompt:

Body-swap effect: [a face] appears on [a completely different body / an animal / an inanimate object], moving and reacting naturally. Seamless, photorealistic, consistent lighting, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: mismatched seam, floating head, wrong proportions, visible compositing.

8.3 - Elastic / Stretchy Body

What it is: The body stretches, squashes, and deforms like rubber. Why it stops: Impossible body physics is a clean cartoon-style interrupt.

AI prompt:

Elastic-body effect: a [person] stretches, squashes, and deforms like rubber, with limbs elongating and the body compressing, then snapping back to normal. Cartoon physics, smooth motion, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: rigid body, no deformation, realistic bone structure, no squash and stretch.

8.4 - Detached Body Parts

What it is: A hand floats and acts on its own, a head detaches, an eye opens where it shouldn't. Why it stops: Detachment of a body part is a primal, uncanny interrupt.

AI prompt:

A [hand / head / eye] detaches from a [person] and [floats / moves / acts] independently, while the person remains otherwise normal. The detached part retains realistic anatomy and lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: blood, gore, horror, attached body part, no independence.

CATEGORY 9: CAMERA & PERSPECTIVE TRICKS

9.1 - Whip-Pan Reveal

What it is: The camera whips rapidly to one side to reveal something surprising. Why it stops: The sudden motion is a salience spike, and the reveal completes an open loop.

AI prompt:

Whip-pan reveal: the camera whips rapidly to the [left/right], motion blurring mid-pan, and lands on [a surprising reveal]. The whip is fast and smooth, then the camera locks. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: slow pan, no motion blur, no reveal, jerky landing.

9.2 - Dutch Angle / Horizon Tilt

What it is: The frame is tilted off-axis - the horizon is at 10-30 degrees, making everything feel "off." Why it stops: A tilted world is a subtle but constant unease signal.

AI prompt:

Dutch angle: the entire scene is tilted [10-30 degrees] off-axis, the horizon angled, creating a subtle feeling of unease and disorientation. [Subject/action continues normally]. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: level horizon, straight camera, balanced composition, no tilt.

9.3 - Forced Perspective

What it is: An optical illusion where scale is manipulated by angle - someone "holding" the sun, or "standing on" a tiny car. Why it stops: The illusion is a satisfying "aha" the viewer feels smart for catching.

AI prompt:

Forced perspective illusion: a [person] appears to [hold / stand on / interact with] a [huge or tiny object] through clever camera angle, creating a playful optical illusion. Single locked camera angle, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: no illusion, mismatched scale, obvious trick, multiple angles.

9.4 - Dolly Zoom (Vertigo Effect)

What it is: The camera zooms in while moving back (or vice versa), making the background stretch while the subject stays the same size. Why it stops: The simultaneous zoom+move is deeply disorienting - a classic "vertigo" shot.

AI prompt:

Dolly zoom (vertigo effect): the camera [zooms in while dollying back], causing the background to stretch and compress dramatically while the subject stays the same size in frame. Cinematic, disorienting, smooth, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: static background, no stretch, normal zoom, fixed perspective.

9.5 - Fourth-Wall Break

What it is: The subject stops and looks directly at the camera, breaking the illusion of being observed.

Why it stops: Direct eye contact is a primal attention trigger; it feels personal.

AI prompt:

Fourth-wall break: mid-[action/scene], the [subject] suddenly stops and looks directly into the camera, [speaking / gesturing] to the viewer as if aware they are being watched. Natural, candid, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: never looking at camera, unaware subject, breaking character unnaturally.

9.6 - POV-to-Reveal

What it is: The shot starts as first-person POV, then pulls back to reveal who/what you were seeing through. Why it stops: The reveal recontextualizes everything - a strong open loop.

AI prompt:

POV-to-reveal: the scene starts in first-person POV [doing an action], then the camera smoothly pulls back to reveal [the actual subject / an unexpected context] that changes the meaning of what was just seen. Seamless transition, 9:16.

Negative prompt: no reveal, staying in POV, hard cut, no recontextualization.

CATEGORY 10: EMOTION & EXPECTATION SUBVERSION

10.1 - Bait & Switch (Context Flip)

What it is: The opening sets up one thing, then the frame reveals it's something entirely different. Why it stops: The cognitive jolt of the pivot forces a re-read.

AI prompt:

Bait-and-switch: the scene opens looking like [one thing, e.g., a luxury product / a romantic moment / a disaster], then a reveal shows it is actually [something completely different]. The pivot is instant and visually clear. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: no pivot, predictable reveal, muddled switch, unclear contrast.

10.2 - The Mask Crack

What it is: A smiling, composed face cracks - the mask slips, revealing real emotion underneath. Why it stops: The emotional reversal is a high-salience human signal.

AI prompt:

The mask crack: a [person] holds a forced smile / calm expression, then the mask visibly cracks - their face shifts to reveal [real emotion: tears, exhaustion, anger] underneath. Raw, intimate, realistic, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: no emotional shift, static expression, cartoonish, melodramatic.

10.3 - Unexpected Reaction

What it is: The subject reacts in a surprising, disproportionate, or opposite way to a situation. Why it stops: The mismatch between stimulus and response is confusing and funny/shocking.

AI prompt:

Unexpected reaction: in response to [a situation], a [person] reacts in a [completely unexpected way - deadpan calm, over-the-top joy, sudden tears]. The contrast between expectation and reaction is the hook. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: predictable reaction, muted response, no contrast, forced acting.

10.4 - Silence / Audio Cut

What it is: The sound abruptly cuts to total silence (with the clock ticking or a single ambient sound), jarring the viewer. Why it stops: Sudden silence is a strong salience drop - the brain checks if something broke.

AI prompt:

Sudden silence: [a scene with normal sound/action] abruptly cuts to total silence, leaving only [a single ambient sound - a clock ticking, a breath, a hum]. The visual continues but the audio vacuum is jarring. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: continuous audio, no silence, no contrast, music filling the gap.

CATEGORY 11: LIGHT & COLOR

11.1 - Selective Color (One Element in Color, Rest B&W)

What it is: The whole scene is black-and-white except ONE element in vivid color. Why it stops: The color isolation is a clean, eye-catching contrast.

AI prompt:

Selective color: the entire scene is [black-and-white / desaturated] except a single [element - a red pepper, a flower, an object] that remains in vivid, saturated color. The contrast isolates the subject. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: full color throughout, no isolation, muted colored element, everything gray.

11.2 - Neon / Dark Contrast

What it is: A dark scene with neon/glowing elements - the "dark room + glowing object" look. Why it stops: High contrast against a dark background is visually loud in a bright feed.

AI prompt:

Neon contrast: a [dark / black] environment with a single [neon-glowing / luminescent element] as the focal point. Deep shadows, vibrant neon rim light, high contrast, cinematic. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: bright flat scene, no contrast, no glow, washed out, evenly lit.

11.3 - Light Leak / Flash

What it is: A burst of light or lens flare overwhelms the frame, transitioning into or out of a scene. Why it stops: A sudden flash is a hard salience spike that resets attention.

AI prompt:

Light-leak transition: a burst of [warm light / lens flare / flash] floods the frame, transitioning from [one scene] into [another]. The flash is brief and smooth, like a film light leak. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: hard cut, no light, no transition, gradual fade only.

11.4 - Color Inversion

What it is: The frame inverts - colors flip to their opposites - creating a sudden "negative film" look. Why it stops: Color inversion is a jarring, unmistakable visual shift.

AI prompt:

Color inversion: [a scene] suddenly inverts - colors flip to their photographic

negatives - then snaps back to normal. The inversion is instant and total, momentarily disorienting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: normal colors throughout, partial inversion, slow fade, no snap.

11.5 - Silhouette Reveal

What it is: The subject is a backlit silhouette against bright light, revealed only in outline. Why it stops: Silhouettes are dramatic, mysterious, and create an open loop ("who/what is this?").

AI prompt:

Silhouette reveal: a [subject] appears as a dramatic backlit silhouette against [bright light - a sunset, a doorway, a window], their features hidden in darkness. The light slowly reveals detail. Cinematic, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: full lighting, visible face, no backlight, no contrast.

CATEGORY 12: TYPOGRAPHY & TEXT

12.1 - Kinetic Text Slam

What it is: Text slams onto the screen with impact - large, bold, in-your-face, timed to a beat or action. Why it stops: Big, fast, high-contrast text is un-missable even on mute.

AI prompt:

Kinetic text: bold text [slams / types / pops] onto the screen in large, high-contrast lettering, timed to [a beat / an action], conveying [a short message]. The text dominates the frame. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: small text, slow text, low contrast, unreadable, no motion.

12.2 - Shatter / Glitch Text

What it is: Text appears, then shatters, glitches, or breaks apart (as in "the lie shatters"). Why it stops: Text destruction is a satisfying, high-salience moment that mirrors the message.

AI prompt:

Shattering text: [a word or phrase] appears on screen, then [shatters like glass / glitches / breaks apart] into fragments, visually mirroring [the message it conveys]. The shatter is sharp and dramatic. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: static text, no break, soft fade, unbroken word.

12.3 - Text-in-World (Text Interacts With the Environment)

What it is: Text is physically part of the scene - a character leans on a word, walks through letters, or the text casts real shadows. Why it stops: The integration of text and world is novel and dimensional.

AI prompt:

Text-in-world: [a word or phrase] exists as a physical object in the scene - the subject [leans on / walks through / interacts with] the 3D text, which casts realistic shadows and occludes correctly. Dimensional, cinematic, 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: flat overlay, no interaction, text not integrated, no shadows.

12.4 - Counting / Numbers Reveal

What it is: A number counts up/down dramatically on screen (dollar amounts, days, stats) as the reveal. Why it stops: Numbers create anticipation - the viewer waits to see the final figure.

AI prompt:

Counting reveal: a [number / statistic] counts up/down rapidly on screen with [dramatic styling], revealing [a final figure], while [a subject/action] plays behind. The number is large and readable. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: static number, no count, unreadable, small text, no build-up.

12.5 - Text Morph (Word Transforms)

What it is: One word morphs into another - "you're broken" becomes "you're growing." Why it stops: The transformation is a satisfying visual metaphor and a clean open loop.

AI prompt:

Text morph: the word [A] transforms smoothly into the word [B], letter by letter, on screen - [e.g., "broken" morphs into "growing"]. The transition is fluid and legible throughout. 9:16 vertical.

Negative prompt: hard cut between words, illegible morph, no transformation, static text.

PART 2 - The AI Video Prompt Formula

Every interrupt prompt in this doc follows the same skeleton. Use this to write your own:

[1. CAMERA & FRAME] - locked camera / slow push-in / whip-pan / dolly-zoom, 9:16 vertical, no unwanted motion

[2. SUBJECT & ACTION] - who/what, and what they are doing, with the interrupt mechanism explicit (float / fall / melt / glitch / morph)

[3. EFFECT / MECHANISM] - the named interrupt, stated plainly, with physical behavior (how the material flows, how the light refracts)

[4. ENVIRONMENT] - background, lighting, mood, texture

[5. STYLE / MEDIUM] - photoreal / 3D / paper collage / claymation / VHS

[6. NEGATIVE PROMPT] - the failure modes to exclude

The single most important rule: state the interrupt *as a physical behavior*, not an abstract adjective.

Write "the water flows upward into the glass" - not "surreal water." AI video models respond to verbs and physics, not vibes.

PART 3 - Universal Negative Prompt Library

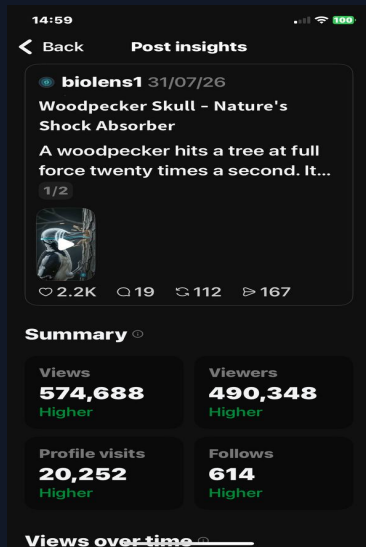
Append these to any prompt to kill the most common AI failures:

frozen limbs, rigid pose, standing, walking normally, floating upright, normal physics, ground contact, strings, wires, visible hands, extra limbs, distorted anatomy, wrong number of fingers, mutated face, blurry subject, jump cuts, broken motion, hard cuts, camera shake, text, watermark, logo, play button, subtitles, cartoonish (unless intended), low quality, low detail, overexposed, underexposed, busy background, extra people

INTERRUPT IN THE WILD

Real content. Real attention. Real examples.

The examples in this section are drawn from real content performance screenshots supplied for the INTERRUPT product. They are evidence of observed performance, not promises that a particular interrupt will produce a particular result. The goal is to study what made the opening visually unusual, then translate the principle into a repeatable creative decision.

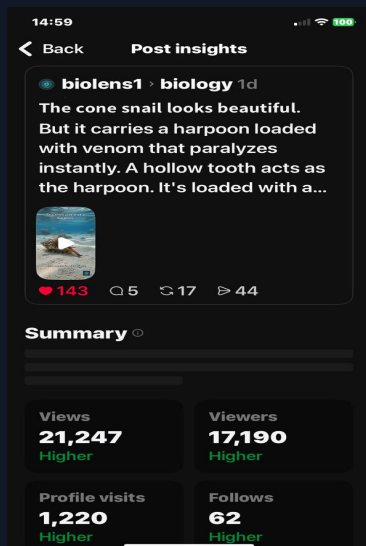


574,688 VIEWS | Woodpecker / visual shock

Observed: The analytics snapshot shows 574,688 views, 490,348 viewers, 20,252 profile visits and 614 follows.

What to notice: A familiar subject is presented with an unexpected visual event. The viewer has a reason to stop and resolve what they are seeing.

Interrupt lens: Likely interrupt: Reality Violation + Curiosity Gap

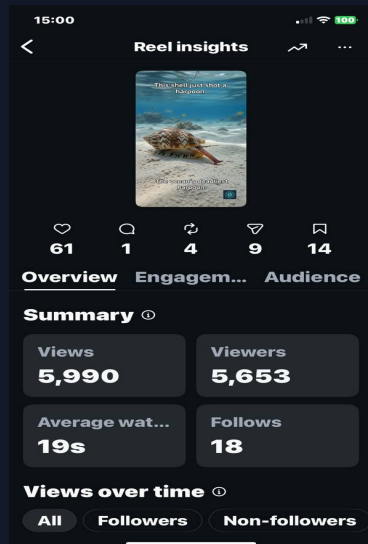


21,247 VIEWS | Cone snail / threat curiosity

Observed: The analytics snapshot shows 21,247 views, 17,190 viewers, 1,220 profile visits and 62 follows.

What to notice: The opening combines an attractive natural subject with a surprising threat mechanism. Beauty creates the click of attention; danger creates the question.

Interrupt lens: Likely interrupt: Emotion + Curiosity Gap

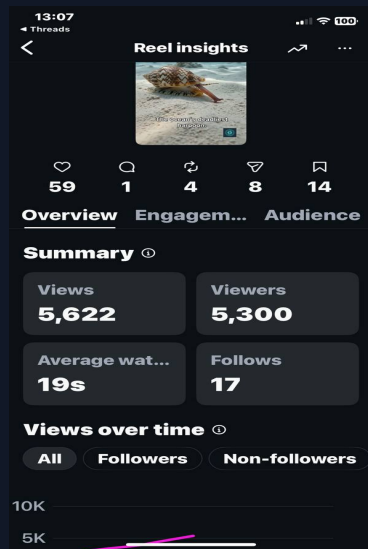


5,990 VIEWS | Cone snail / close-up

Observed: The analytics snapshot shows 5,990 views, 5,653 viewers, 19 seconds average watch time and 18 follows.

What to notice: A visually unusual subject is given immediate screen priority. The viewer does not need context before the image becomes interesting.

Interrupt lens: Likely interrupt: Salience + Curiosity



5,622 VIEWS | Cone snail / repeatable visual hook

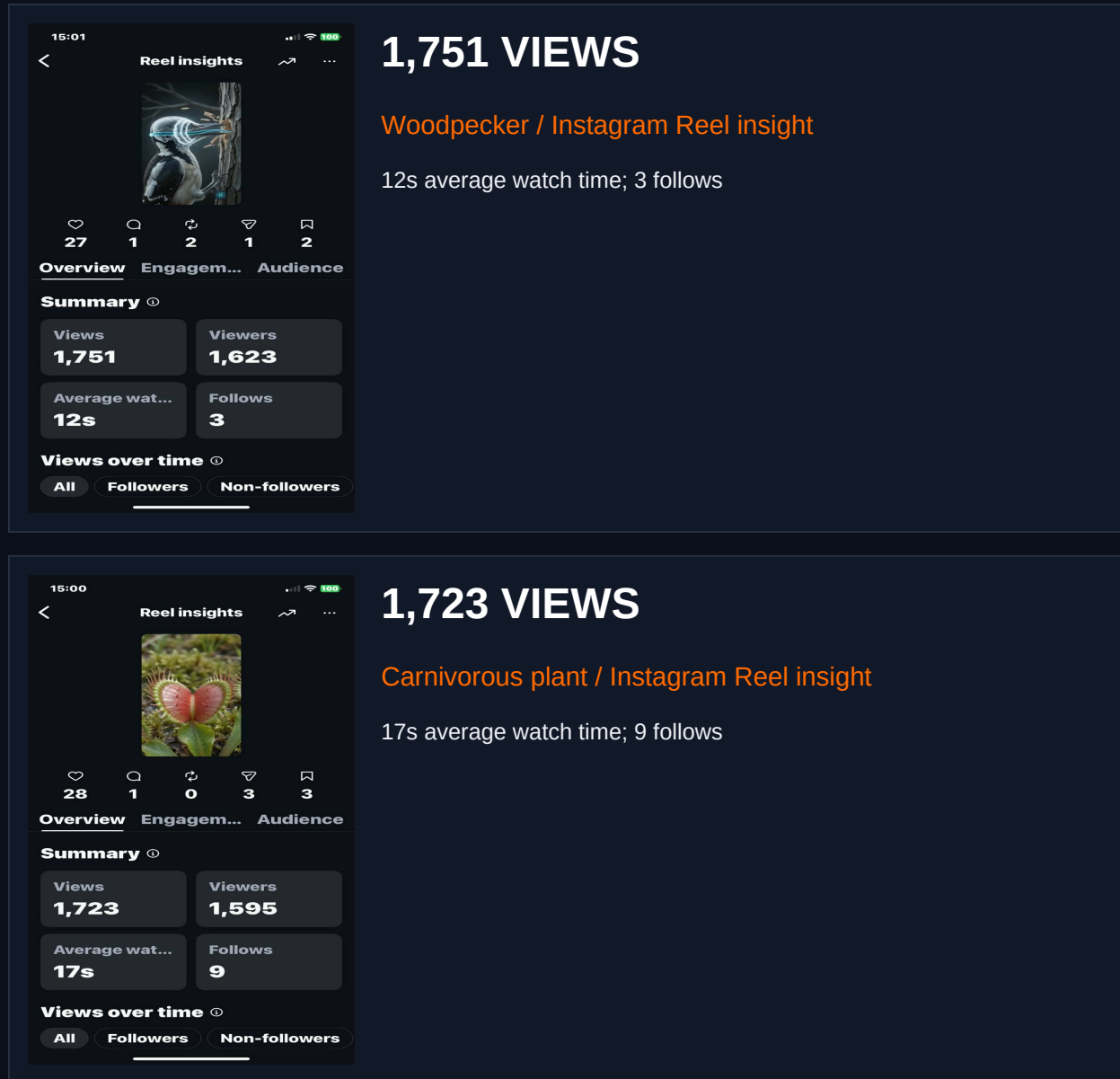
Observed: The analytics snapshot shows 5,622 views, 5,300 viewers, 19 seconds average watch time and 17 follows.

What to notice: The pattern can work repeatedly when the subject itself creates a strong visual question and the first frame carries enough information to invite inspection.

Interrupt lens: Likely interrupt: Curiosity Gap + Visual Salience

MORE PROOF SNAPSHOTS

Smaller wins still matter because they show the system is not dependent on a single outlier.



HOW TO USE THE PROOF

Do not copy the subject. Copy the mechanism. A creator does not need a woodpecker, a snail or a rare animal to use an interrupt. The transferable skill is to identify the visual expectation, break it or intensify it, and give the viewer a reason to keep watching. This is the bridge from inspiration to an actual creative system.

Important: Performance varies by topic, audience, platform, timing and execution. These screenshots document observed results only.